

PEAD call — CHEATSHEET (Tue 23 Jun, 1:00–4:00 pm, online)

Glance-card for the call. Full reasoning: buertey_meeting_brief.md.

Room (3)

- **Samuel Buertey** — DR200 lead. Accounting/ESG (h-12, 100% CSR/disclosure, **0 asset-pricing**). *Topic gatekeeper*.
- **Anh Tuan Nguyen** — Finance co-sup, UTA PhD, REIT mispricing. **Your method ally on EITHER path**. Junior (h-3) — pin alpha framing to him, but he can't anchor alone.
- **Hà Xuân Sơn** — AI/blockchain (~1.7k cites, CS not finance). **Also leads the LLM project #192**. AI muscle, no asset-pricing judgment.

Goal

Find the right *home* for ONE interest across two adjacent projects. - **Target**: LLM #192 under **DR203 (Finance)** + a finance co-sup. - **Fallback**: PEAD #247 — if its framing can be made predictive. - Leave with **PEAD intact** either way. Don't burn the fallback.

The one thing to learn

Is the thesis judged on **predicting returns OOS, after costs** — or on **explaining** over/under-reaction? That answer routes everything.

SAY (in order)

1. **Open — shared ground, legitimise both projects** > “Both your DR200 sentiment project and Son's LLM project sit on the same ground I care about — sentiment, LLMs, earnings reactions, anomalies. I wanted to figure out which is the right home for the question I'd want to answer.”
2. **Frame myself (honest, QR)** > “My background's a quant desk, so I instinctively frame a sentiment question as ‘does this predict returns out-of-sample, after costs.’ I want to check that fits how you'd build the thesis.”
3. **THE decisive question — neutral either/or, ask early** > “Would the thesis be judged on whether the sentiment signal **predicts returns out-of-sample, after costs**, or on **explaining** investors' over/under-reaction to earnings? I want to build toward the right one.”
4. **Supervision split (gets method-ownership WITHOUT asking for it)** > “Since it spans accounting, finance and AI across the three of you — how would supervision divide up? Who would I mainly work with on the empirical / asset-pricing side, versus the sentiment-extraction and earnings-surprise pieces?” > → **Let Buertey describe it first**. Anh handed the empirical lead = confirmed.

READ the answers

Signal	GREEN (predictive)	RED (explanatory)
Q1 wording	“predict / survive costs / trad- able”	“establish / explain the chan- nel”
Q2 method	“walk-forward / hold-out / backtest”	“panel / fixed effects” · qual = hard red flag
Q4 split	“you’d work with Anh on the empirical side”	“I’d guide all empirical fram- ing myself”

(Q3 sentiment-source = already GREEN: broad social/news, not ESG disclosure. Don’t relitigate.)

IF PEAD stays EXPLANATORY → pivot to Son, in the room

“Son — your LLM project’s brief frames exactly what I’m after: predicting asset prices, benchmarking vs factor models, capturing signals traditional quant misses. Given my desk background and QR goal, would that be the better fit — run under **DR203** so it’s examined as finance, with **Anh on board** for the asset-pricing method?”

Two structural asks for the LLM path (the prong it lacks): 1. Confirm LLM #192 can enrol under **DR203 (Finance)**, not Business/mgmt. 2. Float **Anh Nguyen** as the finance co-sup (LLM team has none).

DON’T

- × Say “your project is 40% organisational behaviour” / cite the FoR critique — private diagnostic.
- × Frame PEAD as “flawed.” Frame as *fit between one interest and two projects*.
- × Ask “will Anh own the method instead of you?” — insults the lead. Ask the split (#4); the answer is the diagnostic.
- × Push back in the room if he claims all empirical framing — note it silently.

Decision rule (on the spot)

- **PEAD green** (predictive + Anh owns method) → take PEAD; LLM = backup.
- **PEAD explanatory AND Son open to LLM-under-DR203 + Anh co-sup** → that’s primary (only config passing all prongs).
- **Neither lands** → no RMIT VN project passes → seriously weigh other venues for a QR PhD.

Card to play if useful

Their own paper: “**Decoding market sentiment: ChatGPT explaining Bitcoin returns**” (China Finance Review Int’l, 2025) — proof the predictive/OOS discipline AND the Buertey/Anh/Son division of labour already work in print.

Logistics

- They pick the time inside 1–4pm. CV already sent (docs/cv/quy-sang-mai-cv.pdf).
- Fit line stays honest: quant/markets side — **not** claiming NLP/generative-AI experience yet.